

From John + Mels
Wedding

FETA AND SUN-DRIED TOMATO TORTA

Delicious indulgence!

Yield: about 4 cups; 20 or more servings

*1/2 pound (2 sticks) unsalted butter,
cut into pieces*

3/4 pound feta cheese, crumbled

*One 8-ounce package cream cheese,
at room temperature*

2 cloves garlic, minced

1 shallot, minced

2 to 4 tablespoons dry vermouth

Ground white pepper and/or hot

pepper sauce or minced, seeded,

and deveined fresh red jalapeño

pepper (page 20) to taste

1/2 cup pine nuts, toasted (page 27)

8 ounces sun-dried tomatoes,

softened and minced (page 22)

*1 cup pesto, homemade (page 47) or
purchased*

1. Combine the butter, cheeses, garlic, shallot, and vermouth in a food processor with the metal blade and process until smooth, or combine in a bowl.
2. Season with the pepper hot pepper sauce.
3. Oil a 4- to 5-cup straight-sided mold, bowl, or pâté terrine. Line with plastic wrap.
4. Layer in all ingredients in any order you wish. I start with pine nuts, then sun-dried tomatoes, pesto, and the cheese mixture. Repeat until the mold is full.
5. Fold the plastic wrap over the top and press gently to compact the layers.
6. Refrigerate until firm, at least 1 hour. Invert onto a platter, remove the plastic, and enjoy!

FAST: Can prepare up to 5 days in advance and refrigerate, or freeze for up to 3 months.

FLASHY: Served with Bagel Chips (page 272), crackers, and/or breads. Garnished with fresh basil leaves, toasted pine nuts, minced fresh parsley, and/or any nontoxic flower or leaves.

FABULOUS: With all layered ingredients mixed into the cheese and then molded.

FURTHER: Use leftovers tossed into hot pasta, on rice, in baked potatoes, or on fish, poultry, beef, or lamb instead of an entree sauce.